

Chapter 52-3

Everyone present collectively gasped.

The director was frantic, frantically giving Liang Shi meaningful looks, nearly blinking his eyes to pieces.

But Liang Shi remained unmoved.

Liang Shi carefully recalled the original body's former "aggressive" attitude and the unruly, unreasonable images from film and television works.

She acted out seven parts of it.

"It's been a while since we last met." Qi Taitai just smiled warmly. "Your temper has really grown."

Liang Shi raised an eyebrow: "Has it? Not bad."

Her tone was flat, yet revealed a few traces of rebellious defiance.

Qi Taitai didn't mind her rudeness either, just stared intently at her. After a while, she suddenly said: "The styling photos you took today are very beautiful. The director says you have great acting talent."

Liang Shi: "..."

That phrase "what business is it of yours" was stuck in her throat. Considering so many people present and the director's reputation, she restrained herself, but still replied uncooperatively: "Not bad."

Zhao Ying tugged at Liang Shi's arm and spoke up at the right moment: "Sorry, our filming is finished and we're planning to leave now. My cousin is already messaging to hurry us up. Really sorry. Auntie, if you want to arrange dinner, let's do it next time."

Qi Taitai looked at Zhao Ying and asked gently: "You two seem to have a very good relationship."

Zhao Ying answered without thinking: "This is my cousin's friend, and I'm her senior, so naturally I have to take care of her more."

"That's nice." Qi Taitai said: "I wouldn't have expected Liang Shi to have so many friends."

Liang Shi: "...?"

Why did this sound so strange?

But with so many people around, Liang Shi was too lazy to ask.

She discovered that the fear in her heart could also be gradually overcome. Probably because Zhao Ying was beside her supporting her, giving her a sense of belonging and security.

She wasn't as afraid of Qi Taitai as she had been initially.

"Liang Shi, come here." Qi Taitai called her. "I have a few words I'd like to say to you."

Liang Shi frowned. Just as she was hesitating, Zhao Ying said quietly: "Don't go."

Then Zhao Ying asked Qi Taitai: "What can't be said openly? Auntie, you're treating me like an outsider here."

"Just some private matters." Qi Taitai looked at her. "I want to ask her about some things regarding my daughter. It wouldn't be convenient for you to hear this."

Zhao Ying: "..."

Qi Taitai continued: "You've known her for a short time, so you probably don't know that my daughter was also one of her good friends. Back then, they were very close—she would often cling to my daughter calling her 'sister.' Never mind."

Qi Taitai put away that reminiscent expression and said gently: "It seems you don't know about this either."

After saying this, she looked at Liang Shi again: "Little friend¹, will you come over?"

—Little friend.

That term she used to call her.

Liang Shi instantly got goosebumps all over.

—Little friend, are you being disobedient?

—Jiao Jiao, bring that little friend over here.

—Little friend, only if you're good can you go home.

...

Liang Shi looked at her, seeming to read what was hidden in the depths of her gaze.

It was despair and gloom intertwined with madness.

She closed her eyes, steadying herself with a hand on Zhao Ying's arm.

Zhao Ying could see her reluctance and immediately advised: "Don't go."

But Liang Shi shook her head. She would have to face this eventually.

What she was facing now wasn't just Qi Taitai, but the deepest fear in her own heart.

"It's okay, Sister Ying." Liang Shi comforted her, then strode forward.

The photography studio had a rest room. Qi Taitai and Liang Shi walked in one after the other.

Everyone was confused.

The director approached Zhao Ying: "What's Liang Shi's background?"

"I don't know." Zhao Ying said: "If you want to know, go ask her yourself."

The director who got rebuffed: "..."

Footnotes: ¹ Little friend: A term of address that can be condescending when used by adults toward other adults, often implying the person is childish or naive